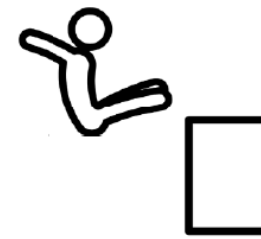


OVERCOMING BARRIERS



WHAT YOU NEED TO DO

Overcoming Barriers



- ❗ Expect barriers and see them as an opportunity to learn and develop.
- ❗ Be ready for the barriers. Identify new solutions (more than just one).
- ❗ Don't give up when barriers arise!
- ❗ Mistakes made in your business are great learning opportunities – value them!
- ❗ Use your resources to overcome barriers. Think about what you have, what you know and who you know.
- ❗ Keep notes on any actions you take to overcome barriers. They will help you prepare for future barriers.
- ❗ Don't allow your frustration with a barrier to distract you, concentrate all your energies on working out how to overcome it.
- ❗ Don't overreact, take a step back and check if the barrier is as big as it seems.



EXERCISE: Identifying Barriers

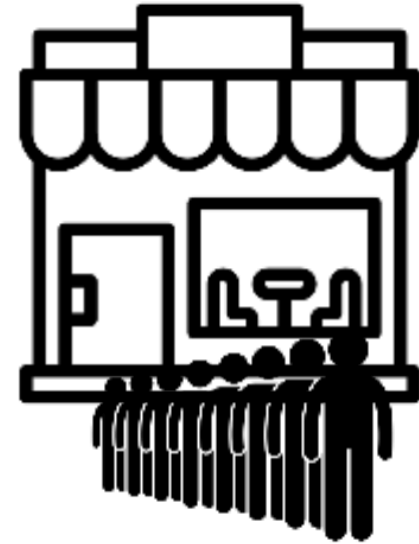


Case study: Luka's Restaurant

Luka's Restaurant is a typical place where you can buy meat, fish and vegetable dishes. The food is greasy but edible. The inside is a bit run down and the prices are average.

Luka, the owner of the restaurant, is upset. He sponsored new shirts for the local school football team. However, he often sees families eating in his competitors' restaurants with children wearing his shirts!. He is frustrated by these ungrateful families.

Luka has also increased his marketing efforts. Once a week he hires a student to distribute flyers with his weekly offers throughout the city. This costs 1,000 Ksh each week. But, so far he hasn't seen any increase in business. When Luka goes home in the evening, he often sees his leaflets discarded on the roadside and feels even more depressed.



(adapted from J. Matson, 1996)



EXERCISE: Identifying Barriers

Although he knows the wages he pays are quite low, Luka is also angry with his employees because they aren't loyal and often quit. It also takes him a long time to find and train new employees.

During bad months, when there are too few customers, Luka has to dip into his own pocket to buy new ingredients.

Last week, Luka's sister Sadiki, who lives abroad and sends money, told him she's not willing to support Luka's restaurant any more. Although he thinks he knows what to do, once again, Luka seems to be stuck.



EXERCISE: Identifying Barriers



Instruction

1. Form **groups of four (04)** people and identify all the barriers Luka is facing. Think about not just the physical barriers e.g. lack of money, but also the barriers in his head e.g. Anger and frustration.

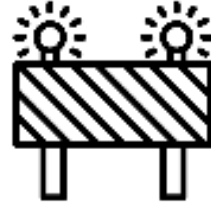
INTERNAL OBSTACLES	EXTERNAL OBSTACLES



EXERCISE: Identifying & Overcoming Barriers



1. Describe the problem
Note the problem



2. Specify the problem

Answer all the questions: What, when / how often? Where? Who?

Why? This makes the problem clearer and finding solutions easier.

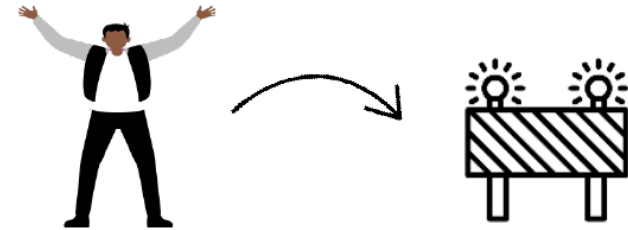
3. Think of as many ways as possible to solve the problem:
 - Use your creativity to find different sources of information that can help solve the problem.
 - Involve your employees, friends, family, suppliers....
4. Specify (and record) the activities needed to solve the problem.

EXERCISE: Identifying Barriers



Instruction

1. Choose one of the obstacles Luka is facing.
2. How can he overcome the obstacle using problem solving techniques?
3. Use the instructions on the previous page to clarify the problem and find possible solutions and fill in Worksheet 5b.
4. Then complete Worksheet 6 to work on a problem in your own business.



THE ENTREPRENEURIAL PROCESS :

